Westvale Public School
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School Council Meeting minutes
September 14, 2022, 6:30pm

Welcome Message – Tonya Veltman

Territorial Acknowledgement – Mary Sue Meredith

Principal's Report – Mary Sue

- Excited to be joining Westvale
- Been an administrator for 6 years
- We have a few new staff members, and will have a few more:
    - Currently hiring for a library clerk and a supervision monitor
    - Mrs. Martin, new kindergarten teacher
    - Mrs. Pedan, new grade 3 teacher
    - Mrs. Brunsting, new grade 5 teacher
    - Ms. Akhtar, new ECE
    - Mr. Lynch, new custodian
- Because of the data breach, communication has been different this year. We are starting to print off some of the forms, and those will be coming home soon.
- Going forward, we will do a lot of things electronically.
- An Instagram account has been set up - wsvwrdsb and there will also be a twitter account
- Two requests from teachers:
    - Would like to continue the tradition of having the humane society visit to provide an age-appropriate slide show and animal visit. A donation for this visit is now being requested because they are experiencing financial strain. A specific dollar amount has not been specified; just a request for donation. (Mrs. Seergobin)
    - Gaga balls for the gaga ball pit are requested. Total cost is $60 ($20 for 2 balls). (Mrs. Julian)
        - Christine motioned to provide $60 for gaga balls and Linda seconded the motion. Majority voted in favor. Motion passed.
- We are hoping for lots of parent volunteers this year, but police checks are required.
    - If parents want to volunteer, you can email Mary Sue
    - There is a 6 week lead on getting the police check completed

    - You can get a letter from Mary Sue, if required for the police check
    - Volunteers will need to complete a Vulnerable Sector Police Check. There is a cost of $20. https://www.wrps.on.ca/en/services-reporting/police-vulnerable-sector-check.aspx
- Pizza Days
    - Mr. Bailey will be looking after pizza days, but we cannot start right away because of the school day issues (we will collect payment via school day).
    - Halal pizza will be offered in addition to cheese and pepperoni.
    - Parent volunteers will be required.
    - Looking for it to be twice a month on Fridays, but this is volunteer dependent.
    - Kids have missed a lot of school, so there is a focus on keeping the children in the classes and learning. So instead of having the grade sixes help, we are looking for parent volunteers at this time.
    - Volunteers so far include Liz Kristensen, Lynda Morris, Jenn Amos, Tammy Lee Hauser, Meredith Perez, Kathleen Siegrist, and Sonali Nair

Teacher's Report – Marisa Moser

- It's been a great start back
- Happy to be able to be back in the classrooms in person, and working in groups
- Excited for the year
- Have the terry fox run coming up on the 22nd
- Orange shirt day is on the 30th
- Request for a bus expense for each classroom for field trips, $250 per bus (15 classes), total of $3750
    - Could classes share buses to save on expenses?
    - Stephanie suggested we table this discussion for later until we have more available funds
    - Donations are possible for WEFI account for Westvale, charitable receipts are available.
    - Tonya to draft a school day email to invite donations. Depending on how much is raised, we could also as for donations during a school event like a movie night.
    - There are currently 412 students, but we are still getting new registrations

Treasurer's Report – Rick Foucault

- Financial Records still have not been confirmed
- There is approximately $7100 in the account
- We keep a min balance of 3k for emergency purposes
- We have over $500 still committed to buy musical instruments for Mrs. Morley

- In total, there are $3500 in commitments (including the minimum balance), so the available funds are just over $3600

Fundraising Overview - Tonya

- We raise funds to respond to requests from staff. Recently we funded the sound system in the gym and the playground as well as providing t-shirts to all students.
- We have several ongoing fundraisers
    - Fundscrip is a fundraiser that allows you to order gift cards for things like gas, groceries, clothing, books, etc. and Westvale receives a portion.
        - https://www.fundscrip.com/support-a-group
        - Use this Invitation Code: B96PEC
        - Enter the school name: Westvale Public School (32679)
    - Mabel's Labels is another ongoing fundraiser, which gives Westvale a portion of proceeds for items bought through their website. https://mabelslabels.ca/en_CA/fundraising/support/
- We received a portion of the food truck sales from meet the educator night ($390!)

Voting for Council Executive

- Positions are being acclaimed
    - Stephanie and Tonya – Co-Chairs
    - Christine – Secretary
    - Rick – Treasurer
- New positions have been added to the executive this year, and these positions are also acclaimed:
    - Event co-ordinator -Aziz Dhamani
    - Communications specialist – Sonali Nair
- Voting Members will include: Liz Kristensen, Emily Cho, Mathew Theis, Kristy Gall, Lynda Morris, Soneli Nair, Christine Glidden, Tamara DeCraemer, Rohit Gotehale, Arlene Vmaekeill, Aziz Dhamani, Meredith Perez, Tammy Lee Hauser, Anita van Raalte, Rick Foucault, and Kathleen Merritt.

Chick Update – Stephanie Evansberg

- Every year we have a large incubator and we hatch chicks, typically in the library
- Last year we set the eggs in April and they hatched in May, and we had a live stream on YouTube
- For this year, we would need to get food and we will need a farm or home that is willing to take up to 7 chicks. Feed is around $40.
- Traditionally this is run in partnership with the Librarian, but we will need to wait until a librarian is hired to determine how it might be run this year

Book Sale – Liz Kristensen

- A used book sale is coming to Westvale! Books will be sold in the gym on October 5th and 6th.
    - Portion of the proceeds will go to council, and a portion will go to the humane society
    - Chapter books $1, Adult books $2, Picture books $0.50
- Donations, please!
    - Picture books, novels, adult books
    - Need lots and lots of donations
    - Donations will be collected from Sept 26th to Oct 4th
- Book Sale Times
    - October 5th 9 am -3:20 pm, students will visit the gym to purchase books
    - October 5th from 3:20 – 6 pm, parents and community members can visit the gym to purchase books
    - October 6th from 3:20 – 6 pm, parents and community members can visit the gym to purchase books
- Volunteers
    - This event requires a lot of volunteers, and anyone interested can contact Liz liz.kristensen@yahoo.ca
    - Qualifies for volunteer hours, teens welcome
    - Volunteers for set up on Tuesday Oct 4th from 3:30 pm -5 pm
    - Volunteers to support book sales from 9 am - 6 pm, Weds Oct 5th
    - Volunteers to support book sales from 3 pm - 6 pm, Thurs Oct 6th
    - Volunteers for clean up/tear down after 6 pm on Thursday Oct 6th

Boohoo Yahoo – Stephanie and Tonya

- There is a Boohoo/Yahoo social event happening on Friday Sept 15th, 2022 in the library at 9 am
- This is for parents/guardians that are new to the school, and provides the opportunity for parents/guardians to meet others
- Mary Sue to send out an email on school day to remind families about the event

Future meeting dates – Mary Sue and Tonya

- Meetings will be held on the first weds of the month, food and childcare will be available
- Meetings are held in the library from 6:30-8 pm
- A hybrid meeting type (virtual + in person) is planned starting in October
- Meeting times are as follows:
    - Oct 5, 6:30 pm – 8 pm
    - Nov 2, 6:30 pm – 8 pm
    - Dec 7, 6:30 pm – 8 pm
    - Feb 1, 6:30 pm – 8 pm
    - Mar 1, 6:30 pm – 8 pm
    - April 5, 6:30 pm – 8 pm

    - May 3, 6:30 pm – 8 pm
    - June 7, 6:30 pm – 8 pm
- Volunteers for food/snacks for the future meetings are as follows:
    - Oct (Emily Cho, Meredith)
    - Nov (Kristy Gall, Tam)
    - Dec (Sonali Nair, Anita van Roalte)
    - Feb (Liz K, Rick)
    - March (Tamara D, Kathleen)
    - April (Rohit G, Tonya)
    - May (Christine G. Bobbi-Joe S.)
    - June (Aziz Dhawani)

Event Planning – Vendor Fair, Bake Sale, Dance, Movie Night - Tonya

- There is interest in fundraisers that build community
- Vendor Fair
    - Vendors (e.g. sweet legs, Tupperware) pay a table fee and the community can come in to purchase from the vendors.
    - Vendors are asked to provide a donation toward a raffle item for a future event (like the music night). We typically charge $40 or $50 for a 6 foot table.
    - Tables typically loaned out from the school board.
- Move-a-Thon/Music Night
    - Michelle is an ECE and a DJ
    - We make a donation to her for her to bring in her equipment in and she plays music all night
    - We ask for a donation at the door, but it is a free event
- Movie night in the gym
    - Event with free popcorn
    - Students get to vote on the movie
    - Donations are asked for at the door, but it is a free event
- Science Fair
    - There is some interest in starting this back up, need to discuss this in future meetings to see if this is possible for this year

Gardens – Emily Cho

- Learning opportunities for all classes
- Looking for a team of volunteers to make it possible for teachers to use the garden as a learning tool
- Food literacy, social justice, and garden education introduced during the winter
- Looking for volunteers to top up the garden beds with compost
- Students are interested in taking responsibility and starting up a gardening club; looking for a teacher sponsor

Next Meeting Date – October 5, 2022 from 6:30-8:00 pm